A GEN-NEXT VISIONARY REIMAGINING THE UNIVERSITY EXPERIENCE

ARADHANA GALGOTIA

Stepping into her role as Chief Operating Officer, Galgotias University with academic zeal, Aradhana Galgotia is on a mission to provide students in India the educational environment needed to excel globally

For Aradhana Galgotia, education is not simply about acquiring a degree or mastering a body of knowledge. Its deeper purpose, she believes, is to teach young people to think: to question assumptions, engage with different perspectives, analyse problems, remain curious and ultimately use knowledge to create meaningful change.

As Chief Operating Officer at Galgotias University, she is attempting to translate that philosophy into practice. Her ambition is not merely to add new programmes or international collaborations, but to create an academic environment in which Indian students have access to the kind of intellectual, technological and global exposure that can prepare them not just for employment, but for an increasingly complex and interconnected world.

After graduating from Jesus and Mary College in New Delhi, Aradhana pursued an LLM in Intellectual Property Rights at Queen Mary University, London and subsequently an MBA at Cambridge Judge Business School, University of Cambridge.

Moving between Indian and European academic environments gave her an unusual vantage point: an understanding of the strengths and realities of Indian higher education, combined with first-hand experience of an international academic culture that places considerable emphasis on independent thinking, discussion, debate, case-based learning, experiential learning and interdisciplinary engagement.



At Cambridge, she encountered an ecosystem in which academic learning was closely connected with entrepreneurship, innovation and the application of ideas to real-world problems. The experience reinforced a conviction that has since become central to her work: the best educational practices should not remain the preserve of a few elite institutions or be accessible only to students who travel abroad.

For Aradhana, global exposure is not synonymous with international travel. It is about changing the way a student sees the world. One of the clearest expressions of this philosophy is Galgotias University's growing association with Girton College, University of Cambridge.

In 2026, 16 Galgotias students were selected for a fully sponsored two-week Graduate Programme at Girton College. The initiative gives students the opportunity to experience an international academic environment, engage with themes such as artificial intelligence, entrepreneurship and innovation, and interact with students and faculty in a setting very different from their regular university experience.

"Having experienced the transformative impact of world-class education myself at Queen Mary University, London and University of Cambridge, I feel strongly that our students should have the opportunity to learn from and engage with the same ecosystem"

– Aradhana Galgotia, COO, Galgotias University